Zisel Jewelry: Product & Competitor Research (Jewelry + Business Model)

Prepared Oct 10, 2026 (PT). Scope: product, pricing, materials, custom/showroom model, holiday promos, trust signals. Website design and social marketing are covered by teammates. All prices are real listed prices seen on **Oct 10, 2026** unless noted, with source links inline. Nothing below is estimated. Sections marked **[Analysis]** are my recommendations, not sourced facts.

Companion file: `competitors.csv` (15 competitors, 3 tiers).

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1. Competitor landscape (15 competitors, 3 tiers)

Tier 1: Las Vegas local, wholesale-to-public and private showroom jewelers (Zisel's direct competition)

Name	Location	Positioning	Signature products / styles
Sky Diamonds	Town Square, 6539 S Las Vegas Blvd	Mizrahi family, 40+ years importing and **wholesaling to other jewelers** before opening to the public in 2019. Pitch: "Transparent value, no brand name markup," private by-appointment consults, lifetime cleaning/sizing/appraisal (about)	"Largest loose diamond selection in Las Vegas," natural + lab side by side, 3D-rendered custom, Rolex
The Jewelers of Las Vegas	2400 Western Ave (near Strip) + Summerlin	Family-owned since 1976, "wholesale jeweler," private consultations, same-day appointments often available (FAQ)	Custom engagement, diamond necklaces, earrings, bracelets, gemstones. "GIA or equivalent" certs. **No refunds**: 90-day exchange for store credit only
D&R House of Diamonds	Downtown Summerlin, 1980 Festival Plaza Dr #530	**"Private office jeweler"**: by appointment only, sit with the two owners, no sales staff. Low overhead means lower prices. "Best of Las Vegas" 9x (source)	Loose mined + lab diamonds, designer/fashion jewelry, CAD custom with on-screen hand preview
DiamondsNColors	8965 S Eastern Ave #160	Private, no-pressure showroom; "strongly recommend" calling ahead for a private appointment	GIA natural, lab, colored gems, custom
The Diamond Store	750 S Rampart Blvd #5	"Leading diamond importer... eliminates the middleman"; walk-ins or private consultation	Diamonds, engagement, custom
MJ Christensen Diamonds	8980 W Charleston (Summerlin) + more	The established local name, 4.9★ from ~2,500 Google reviews (listing)	Designer brands (Hearts on Fire, Forevermark, Gabriel & Co.), own MJ Signature line, lab-grown, custom via CAD and **wax try-on**
Jeffrey White Custom Jewelry	Tivoli Village, 410 S Rampart #160	Bespoke studio; publishes clear timelines and holiday lead-time warnings	Custom engagement and fine jewelry
Dumoni Jewelers	Downtown, 353 E Bonneville Ave	In-house master jeweler, "nothing outsourced," **publishes a price menu**, takes Zelle/CashApp, Calendly booking	Custom gold chains, pendants, earrings, rings, grillz in 10k/14k/18k/24k

Also seen: the Meadows Mall cluster (Kay, Zales, "The Jewelry District" store at 4300 Meadows Ln) and T-Bird Jewels (1013 S Rampart, 4.9★/642) (listing). Gold buyers like Nevada Coin Mart note the **Cuban link is the most common chain seen in Las Vegas**.

Key pattern: almost no Vegas independent posts prices online. They all compete on "wholesale/importer roots + private appointment + lifetime care."

Tier 2: Online DTC and mass retail (where customers price-check)

Name	Positioning	Signature products
Brilliant Earth	Lab + natural side by side, IGI/GIA reports, free shipping/returns, free lifetime warranty, Affirm 0% up to 36 mo, ~45 showrooms (none listed in Las Vegas)	Lab tennis bracelets/necklaces, bezel styles, studs, design-your-own earrings/necklaces
Blue Nile	Big online catalog, natural/lab toggle on every item, frequent % off, free overnight shipping, lifetime product warranty	Studs, tennis bracelets, pendants, loose diamonds
Mejuri	Everyday "self-purchase" fine jewelry, 14k solid 90% recycled gold, 2-yr warranty	Gold chains, huggies, stacking pieces, fine tennis bracelets
Kay (Signet)	Mall chain with a store at Meadows Mall LV, permanent "35% off" pricing, 30-day returns	Lab studs, tennis, gold chains

Tier 3: Luxury references (all have boutiques on the Strip)

Tiffany has boutiques at Wynn, Bellagio, Crystals, and Forum Shops. The Shops at Wynn also host Graff, Cartier, Van Cleef & Arpels, and Bulgari.

Brand	Icon	Listed price
Tiffany & Co.	Victoria tennis bracelet, platinum, 1.82 ct tw	**$16,400**, non-returnable (exchange only) (tiffany.com)
Cartier	LOVE bracelet, classic yellow gold	$7,950 US (secondary price tracker; Cartier's page didn't show a price to my fetch) (streetstylis)
Van Cleef & Arpels	Vintage Alhambra 5-motif necklace	$12,500 (secondary tracker) (streetstylis)

Lesson from luxury: each brand owns **one recognizable silhouette** (Love screw, Alhambra clover, Victoria marquise flower).

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2. What's selling: earrings, bracelets, necklaces (2025–2026)

- **Tennis bracelets are the #1 holiday gift.** "No girl has ever said, 'I don't want a tennis bracelet,'" designer Dana Gordon told National Jeweler. Tennis/rivière necklaces are right behind, and both are worn by men and women (Beyond Two Rings, citing National Jeweler).
- **Diamond essentials** (tennis bracelets, pendants, studs) are "the foundation." Studs now anchor a "curated ear," and tennis bracelets are stacked with chunky chains (Brilliant Earth 2026 trends).
- **Chains:** paperclip, herringbone, and rope link styles define necklaces (Brilliant Earth). Layering two chain lengths or a chain + pendant is a top gift move (Dainty London). Cuban link is the dominant chain in Las Vegas (Nevada Coin Mart).
- **Earrings:** huggies and sculptural or inside-out hoops are beating plain hoops (Dainty London; Whiteflash 2026 holiday). Studs remain the "first fine-jewelry gift."
- **Bezel settings, yellow gold, mixed shapes** (pear instead of round), **charms/initials/medallions** for personalization (Beyond Two Rings; Brilliant Earth).

- Fashion is moving toward **bolder gold** (cuffs, oversized hoops) and "everyday diamonds" (Marie Claire 2026).

Trend sources to keep watching: National Jeweler, JCK, Brilliant Earth trend guide, Marie Claire jewelry trends.

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3. Materials and anchor prices

Market context

- **Natural diamonds:** a 1 ct stone averages **$3,898**, down 51% from $8,007 in 2021 (Rapaport via CNBC, Sep 26 2026). De Beers paused its Venetia mine, and some see "the beginning of a recovery."
- **Lab-grown:** 61% of 2025 engagement rings had lab centers (The Knot, via CNBC). A comparable lab stone was ~$450 vs $2,800–3,200 natural on Brilliant Earth (CNBC). Lab gross margins run **60–65% vs 40–45% for naturals** (Gordon Brothers, via CNBC). Wholesale lab prices fell 26% in 2025 and 13% YoY in Q2 2026 but are stabilizing, with 1 ct rounds up 1%. US specialty lab jewelry sales rose 24% in Q2 (JCK, Jul 8 2026).
- **Gold:** spot settled **$4,195.60/oz on Oct 9, 2026** (Gold Market Daily), ~22–25% below the January 2026 record. Gold-weight pieces (chains, hoops, cuffs) carry high material cost, so semi-solid/hollow and lower karats matter.
- **Karats:** 10k = 41.7% gold (most durable/affordable), **14k = 58.3% ("the sweet spot," most popular for custom)**, 18k = 75% (richer color, premium) (Dumoni).

Anchor price table (listed prices, seen Oct 10, 2026)

Item	Retailer	Spec	Price	Source
1 ct tw studs, **natural**	Blue Nile	Six-prong, 14KW, H-I/SI	$3,820 list / **$2,674 sale**	link
1 ct tw studs, **natural**	Blue Nile	Halo, 14KW, H-I/SI	$2,550 list / **$1,785 sale**	link
1 ct tw studs, **lab**	Kay	14KW, F/SI2, certified	**$909.99** (was $1,399.99; out of stock)	link
Tennis bracelet, **natural**	Blue Nile	7", 2 ct tw, 14KW, H-I/SI	**$3,730**	link
Tennis bracelet, **natural**	Mejuri	1.3 mm, ~0.82–1.03 ct, 14k YG, GHI/SI-I	**from $2,600**	link
Tennis bracelet, **lab**	Brilliant Earth	6", 3 ct tw, 14KW, F/G VS, IGI	**$2,850**	link
Tennis bracelet, **lab** (promo)	Van Adams Jewelers (GA independent), Black Friday 2025	14k, 2 ct / 3 ct	**$1,295 / $1,595**	link
14k gold chain	Kay	Rope, semi-solid, 18", 2.4 mm	**$844.99** (was $1,299.99)	link
14k gold chain	Mejuri	Round box, solid, 2.5 mm, 20"	**from $1,900**	link
Luxury tennis	Tiffany	Victoria, platinum, 1.82 ct	**$16,400**	link

[Analysis] "Wholesale pricing" only lands if Zisel visibly beats these numbers on comparable specs. The comparisons customers will make are: lab 1 ct tw studs (under $910 Kay sale), lab 3 ct tennis (under $2,850

Brilliant Earth, and local promos already at $1,595), natural 2 ct tennis (under $3,730 Blue Nile), and 14k chains priced by weight and solidity.

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4. Custom process, lead times, private showroom model

Typical custom flow: consult → sketch/CAD (days, plus 1–2 revision rounds) → stone sourcing → wax or 3D print try-on (MJ Christensen) → casting, setting, finishing → pickup (Jeffrey White; MJ Christensen).

Jeweler	Advertised lead time	Deposit / terms
Dumoni (LV)	Chains, pendants, earrings **1–3 wks**; engagement 3–6 wks	**$1,000 CAD deposit**, credited; full payment at pickup; lifetime craftsmanship warranty (source)
Jeffrey White (LV)	Custom 4–12 wks; simple mods 2–3 wks; **add 2–4 wks Nov–Feb**; start 12–14 wks ahead for holiday proposals; jewelers stop taking holiday orders weeks early (source)	Quoted per project
D&R (LV)	Not stated; CAD with on-hand screen preview	Free consultation booked online or by phone (source)

Private appointment and showroom models in Vegas: - By appointment only, private office: D&R. You meet the owners in a Summerlin office suite, and lower overhead is the selling point. - **Showroom + "private consult" option:** Sky Diamonds, The Diamond Store, The Jewelers ("same-day appointments often available"), DiamondsNColors ("call ahead" recommended). - **Booking channels:** online form (D&R, The Jewelers), phone, Calendly (Dumoni). Brilliant Earth's booking flow is a good template: pick service (Engagement 50 min / **Fine Jewelry & Gifts 50 min** / drop-off 15 min), date/time, SMS reminders (BE product page booking modal). - **Showing-party model (outside Vegas):** direct-sales hosts earn rewards. Park Lane gives the host a favorite item for $35 and $40 free credit at 10+ orders, ships directly to guests, and lets parties run virtually or in a restaurant/clubhouse (Park Lane host). Fine-jewelry trunk shows commonly give hosts 10–20% of sales in jewelry (per search summary of trunk-show programs, not individually verified).

[Analysis] No Vegas fine jeweler I found is marketing *showing parties*. That model is owned by costume/direct-sales brands, so it's open white space for Zisel.

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5. Holiday promo tactics (real examples)

2026 calendar: Hanukkah runs **sundown Fri Dec 4 – nightfall Sat Dec 12, 2026** (AJLuxe). Christmas is Dec 25. Valentine's is Sun Feb 14, 2027.

- **Gift-with-purchase diamonds** (the dominant tactic):
- Brilliant Earth Black Friday 2025 (Nov 15–29): free ½ ct lab studs over $1,000, studs + lab necklace over $3,000, code BLACKFRIDAY (StyleCaster). They're running it again right now: free ¼ ct lab studs over $1,000, Oct 4–10, 2026 (BE).
- Van Adams: free 1 ct lab studs ("valued at $895") with $1,000+, plus "special buy" lab tennis bracelets at $1,295 (2 ct) and $1,595 (3 ct) (Van Adams).
- Arden Jewelers: free natural or lab studs over $2,000 through Dec 24 (Arden).

- **Doorbuster hero items:** Van Adams marked a natural 10 ct riviera necklace from $15,995 to $9,995 and petite 14k diamond pendants from $695 to $495 (source).
- **Hanukkah:** "eight nights" framing. Small pieces most nights (studs, slim pendant), one bigger piece on one night. Star of David pendants in 14k for those who wear Jewish symbols (OD's Jewellers; AJLuxe).
- **Valentine's:** windowed sales plus a clear "order by" date. Samuelson's ran up to 30% off Feb 6–16 with order by Feb 11 (LinkedIn post). Major brands set Feb 11–12 deadlines (USA Today).
- **List-building sweepstakes:** Brilliant Earth gives away a $1,000 gift card for email/SMS signup (Oct 2026) and a $2,500 "Win Your Wish List" sweepstakes. Every product has a "Drop a Hint" button (BE).
- **Proposal-season urgency:** Nov–Feb is proposal season. Custom orders need 2–4 extra weeks, so "book by" deadlines are a legitimate hook (Jeffrey White).

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6. Trust signals buyers expect

- **Grading reports:** IGI still issues full 4Cs reports for lab-grown. **Since Oct 1, 2025, GIA no longer gives D–Z/clarity grades for lab-grown**, only a "Premium" or "Standard" quality assessment (National Jeweler; GIA). So: **IGI for lab, GIA for natural** is the norm (Brilliant Earth's lab tennis bracelet ships with an IGI report). Kay laser-inscribes certified lab centers.
- **Disclosure law (must-do):** under the FTC Jewelry Guides, lab-grown stones must be clearly and conspicuously described as "laboratory-grown," "laboratory-created," or "[manufacturer]-created" immediately next to the word "diamond." A disclosure buried in an FAQ or hashtag may not suffice (FTC). This applies to texts, flyers, and the website.
- **Warranties:** Blue Nile and Brilliant Earth offer lifetime product warranties, Mejuri 2 years, Dumoni a lifetime craftsmanship warranty. Sky Diamonds offers lifetime cleaning/sizing/appraisal.
- **Returns:** online sets the bar at **free 30-day returns** (Brilliant Earth, Kay). Local independents are stricter: The Jewelers has no refunds and 90-day store-credit exchanges, and custom pieces are non-returnable almost everywhere (Kay, The Jewelers, BE engraved items). Tiffany's Victoria bracelet is exchange-only.
- **Financing:** Brilliant Earth offers Affirm 0% APR up to 36 months, Wells Fargo 12-month financing, and layaway. Bank wire gets 1.5% off (BE).
- **Upgrade programs:** Brilliant Earth gives full-credit lifetime diamond upgrades, and Kay offers lifetime lab-grown trade-in.
- **Social proof:** MJ Christensen's ~2,500 reviews at 4.9★ and D&R's "Best of Las Vegas 9x" are the local benchmarks.

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7. Opportunities and gaps for Zisel [Analysis, not sourced facts]

1. **Price transparency is the gap.** Every Vegas independent hides prices, while online shows them. Zisel can publish "from" prices or a short wholesale price menu (Dumoni proves a public menu works locally) for 5–8 hero items next to the Blue Nile/Brilliant Earth comparable. That makes "wholesale" provable instead of a slogan.
2. **Own showing parties.** Fine-jewelry home and suite showings are unclaimed in Vegas. Package it: host gets a gift (e.g., lab studs) plus credit tied to party sales, with a minimum guest count. Run it in homes,

suites, or Ben's showroom, using Park Lane's structure at fine-jewelry price points.

3. **Lead with a tight hero assortment, not a catalog:** lab and natural tennis bracelets (2–3 ct), 1 ct tw studs, huggies, a tennis necklace, 14k chains (Cuban, rope, paperclip) plus a diamond pendant, and a holiday-only motif (Star of David, cross, initial, heart). This matches what's selling and what Vegas wears.
4. **Two-lane diamond story:** lab = "more size per dollar" (plus higher margin, 60–65%). Natural = "heritage," priced near historic lows (1 ct avg $3,898). Show both side by side like Sky Diamonds and Brilliant Earth, with FTC-compliant labels.
5. **Holiday GWP beats % off for wholesale positioning.** Discounting undermines "already wholesale." A gift with purchase (free lab studs over a threshold) matches the market standard without signaling inflated base prices.
6. **Use custom as the urgency lever.** Publish "order custom by ___ for Hanukkah (Dec 4) / Christmas / Valentine's" deadlines based on a 1–3 week simple-piece timeline (Dumoni's benchmark), plus 2–4 weeks for holiday load.
7. **Signature silhouette.** Luxury wins on one recognizable motif. A "diamond over the i" detail could become a small diamond-dot motif on clasps and pendants, a cheap and ownable brand code.
8. **Match online trust basics** that local stores don't advertise: IGI/GIA report with every center stone, a written warranty, a clear exchange policy (custom final sale), and Affirm-style financing.
9. **Weekend/tourist access:** MJ Christensen closes Sundays and D&R is appointment-only. Evening and weekend private showings for locals and visitors are a differentiator.
10. **Gold price risk:** with spot near $4,200, quote chains by weight and solidity, offer 10k/semi-solid entry options, and hold quotes for a short window.

Caveats: Cartier and Van Cleef prices come from a secondary price tracker, because the brand pages didn't expose prices to my fetcher. Trunk-show host percentages come from a search summary. The Kay 1 ct lab stud was out of stock when seen. No competitor was contacted.